

SAAD WASEEM

Cloud & DevOps Engineer | AWS, Docker, Terraform, CI/CD | Django Backend

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SUMMARY

Cloud and DevOps focused developer with 2+ years of freelance delivery for international clients (US, Portugal) and hands-on experience operating a production Linux workload on AWS. Comfortable across the full delivery path: Django/Django REST Framework services, Docker containerisation, Terraform provisioning, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Nginx/Gunicorn, and EC2/RDS/S3 deployment, plus live production troubleshooting on Ubuntu. Seeking a junior DevOps / Cloud Engineer role with backend responsibilities.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **AWS:** EC2, S3, RDS (PostgreSQL), ECR, ECS/Fargate, ALB, CloudFront, Route 53, IAM, CloudWatch, Secrets Manager, Amplify
- **Infrastructure as Code & Automation:** Terraform (modules, variables, plan/apply, remote state in S3 with DynamoDB locking), GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines, Bash scripting
- **Containers:** Docker, Dockerfiles, Docker Compose, multi-service local environments, image build and push to Amazon ECR; Kubernetes (basic hands-on: pods, deployments, services, `kubectl`)
- **Linux & Web Servers:** Ubuntu administration, SSH, process management (PM2, systemd), Nginx reverse proxy, Gunicorn, Certbot SSL/TLS, DNS configuration, log analysis and production troubleshooting
- **Backend:** Python, Django, Django REST Framework, REST API design, JWT authentication (SimpleJWT), role-based access control, django-filter, pagination, Swagger/OpenAPI documentation; Node.js/TypeScript (build and deployment level)
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, SQLite, Django ORM, schema migrations
- **Version Control & Workflow:** Git, GitHub, branching, pull-request workflow, separate application and infrastructure repositories
- **Web Fundamentals (supporting):** HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, React/Vite, WordPress
- **Currently building depth in:** pytest, ECS Fargate autoscaling, Kubernetes fundamentals

EXPERIENCE

Backend & DevOps Engineer (Freelance)

Thinkwell — Remote (US client)

Jun 2026 – Aug 2026

- Operated a production Node.js/TypeScript backend on an AWS EC2 Ubuntu instance, covering Nginx reverse proxy configuration, PM2 process supervision, Redis availability, environment variables, DNS records and SSL/TLS certificates.
- Diagnosed a recurring production build failure as an out-of-memory kill on an instance with roughly 908 MB of usable RAM, then adjusted the Node.js build strategy so TypeScript compilation completed reliably.
- Traced a persistent service startup failure to an application entry-path mismatch (`dist/index.js` versus `dist/src/index.js`) by reading build output and PM2 logs, and corrected the process configuration to restore the service.
- Executed a server/environment migration using an EC2 AMI snapshot, sequencing DNS and certificate changes to keep downtime minimal.
- Documented deployment steps, log locations and recovery actions so the client could restart and verify the stack without developer assistance.

Freelance Web & Cloud Developer

Remote — US, Portugal and direct clients (Upwork / Fiverr)

2024 – Present

- Delivered responsive multi-page client websites on WordPress and custom HTML/CSS/JavaScript stacks, handling domain registration, hosting setup, theme/plugin configuration and content structure end to end.
- Containerised and deployed Django applications to AWS EC2 behind Nginx and Gunicorn, wiring environment configuration, static/media storage on S3 and HTTPS via Certbot.
- Collaborated with a remote team to debug defects in a live production codebase, reproducing issues locally, isolating root causes and shipping fixes through Git pull requests.
- Automated repeat deployment steps with GitHub Actions and Docker, replacing manual server-side build commands with a repeatable pipeline.

PROJECTS

MyCraft Theme Web Application

HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript, Responsive Web Design

- Developed an interactive Minecraft-themed web application with a custom responsive interface, themed UI components and embedded gameplay functionality.
- Implemented the frontend with responsive layouts and optimized client-side assets for a fast and accessible experience across desktop and mobile devices.

Personal Portfolio Platform — saadops.site

React/Vite, Django REST Framework, Docker, AWS EC2,

Terraform, GitHub Actions

- Built a decoupled portfolio platform with a React/Vite frontend and a Django REST Framework backend, enabling dynamic management of projects, blogs and professional experience through the Django administration panel instead of hard-coded content.
- Containerised and deployed the Django backend to Amazon EC2 using Docker, with AWS infrastructure provisioned through Terraform and production traffic handled through Nginx and Gunicorn.
- Configured GitHub Actions for automated build and deployment workflows, enabling application changes committed to the repository to be propagated to the live AWS environment.

Django REST API — AWS Container Infrastructure

Django REST Framework, Docker, Terraform, AWS

ECR, ECS, GitHub Actions

- Developed and containerised a Django REST Framework application and provisioned its AWS infrastructure as Code using Terraform.
- Implemented an AWS container deployment using Amazon ECR and Amazon ECS, with GitHub Actions configured to automate image building, publishing and application deployment.
- Provisioned supporting AWS networking and application resources through Terraform, creating a reproducible infrastructure and deployment workflow.

ThinkWell — Production Django REST Platform

Django REST Framework, Docker, Terraform, AWS ECS

Fargate, ECR, RDS, GitHub Actions

- Built and deployed a production-oriented Django REST Framework platform using Docker and Infrastructure as Code with Terraform, implementing a scalable AWS architecture for containerised application workloads.
- Configured Amazon ECR and ECS Fargate for container deployment and horizontal scaling, with GitHub Actions providing automated build, image publishing and deployment pipelines.
- Provisioned AWS networking, RDS PostgreSQL and supporting infrastructure through Terraform, separating application configuration from reusable infrastructure definitions.

E-Commerce Platform — AWS Production Infrastructure

Django REST Framework, Docker, Terraform,

AWS ECS Fargate, ECR, RDS, NAT Gateway, Secrets Manager, GitHub Actions, Helm, Prometheus, Grafana, Loki

- Built and deployed a containerised e-commerce platform on AWS using Terraform-managed infrastructure, ECS Fargate, Amazon ECR, RDS PostgreSQL and a production VPC architecture with private networking and NAT Gateway.
- Implemented AWS Secrets Manager for secure application secrets and configured GitHub Actions for automated CI/CD, including container image builds, ECR publishing and deployment to ECS Fargate.
- Implemented container orchestration and deployment tooling with Helm and established an observability stack using Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for application and infrastructure monitoring, metrics and logs.
- Configured scalable ECS Fargate workloads with automated scaling and resource management to support changing application demand while maintaining a reproducible Infrastructure-as-Code workflow.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science — University of South Asia, Lahore

Expected 2027